

CYROPAEDIA, VII. v. 7-10

7. When they had encamped, Cyrus called together his staff-officers and said : " Friends and allies, we have viewed the city on every side. But I am sure I cannot see how any one could take by storm walls so massive and so high ; but the more men there are in the city, the sooner they can, I think, be brought by famine to capitulate, seeing that they will not come out and fight. Therefore, unless you have some other method to suggest, I propose that we use this method of laying siege to those gentlemen."

Cyrus plans
for a siege

8. " But," said Chrysantas, " does not this river flow through the midst of the city ? And it is more than two stadia in width."

" Aye, by Zeus," said Gobryas, " and its depth is such that two men, one standing on the other's shoulders, would not reach the surface of the water, so that the city is better defended by the river than by its walls."

9. " Chrysantas," Cyrus answered, " let us not trouble ourselves with that which is beyond our powers ; but we must apportion the work among ourselves as quickly as possible, to each contingent its proper share, and dig a ditch as wide and as deep as possible, so that we may require only as many men on guard as are absolutely indispensable."

He proposes
to divert the
Euphrates

10. Accordingly, he took measurements in a circle round about the city, leaving just enough room by the river for the erection of large towers, and began